

BIS Services, Certification Schemes and Consumer Channels · Overview (S

1. WHAT THE BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS DOES

The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) is India's national standards body, set up under the BIS Act 2016. It formulates Indian Standards, operates product certification schemes (the ISI mark scheme and the Compulsory Registration Scheme), runs the hallmarking scheme for gold and silver, manages laboratory recognition and testing services, and provides consumer grievance and awareness channels.

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2. PRODUCT CERTIFICATION SCHEMES

The Product Certification Schemes operate through licences granted to manufacturers whose products and factory-level quality control conform to the relevant Indian Standard. Certified products carry the ISI mark with a CM/L licence number. The Compulsory Registration Scheme (CRS) covers electronics and IT goods: manufacturers register declarations of conformity and self-declare testing to the relevant standard, and registered goods carry the BIS registration mark with an R-number. Which products are mandatory is determined by Quality Control Orders and ministry notifications; the current lists must be verified on the official BIS source.

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3. HALLMARKING AND TESTING SERVICES

The hallmarking scheme covers gold and silver jewellery assayed and marked by BIS-recognised Assaying and Hallmarking Centres. BIS also operates and recognises laboratories for testing, and laboratory recognition services for other testing facilities. Consumers and manufacturers can use the BIS laboratories and services through the official portals.

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4. STANDARDS DEVELOPMENT AND CONSUMER PARTICIPATION

Indian Standards are developed through technical committees with industry, regulators, academia and consumer participation. Standards Clubs in educational institutions, Standards National Months activities and training programmes are the main awareness channels. MSMEs and startups can access hand-holding, registration fee concessions and simplified application routes announced from time to time; verify current schemes on the official BIS source.

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5. CONSUMER COMPLAINTS AND VERIFICATION CHANNELS

Consumers can report misuse of the ISI mark, unmarked mandatory products, defective certified products and hallmarking grievances through BIS online complaint channels, the BIS Care mobile application and the consumer grievance portal. The BIS Care app also verifies HUID codes and licence details. For escalations, consumer commissions under the Consumer Protection Act remain available.